

CAPCOM

ストリートファイター X テkken
STREET FIGHTER
X TEKKEN ARTWORKS
アートワークス



ストリートファイターX 鉄拳 ビジュアル

This section covers a wide variety of visual elements, from official art for game packages to exclusive art for this book, as well as character portraits and cinematics, all complete with comments from the creators.

STREET

FIGHTER

TEKKEN

VISUALS





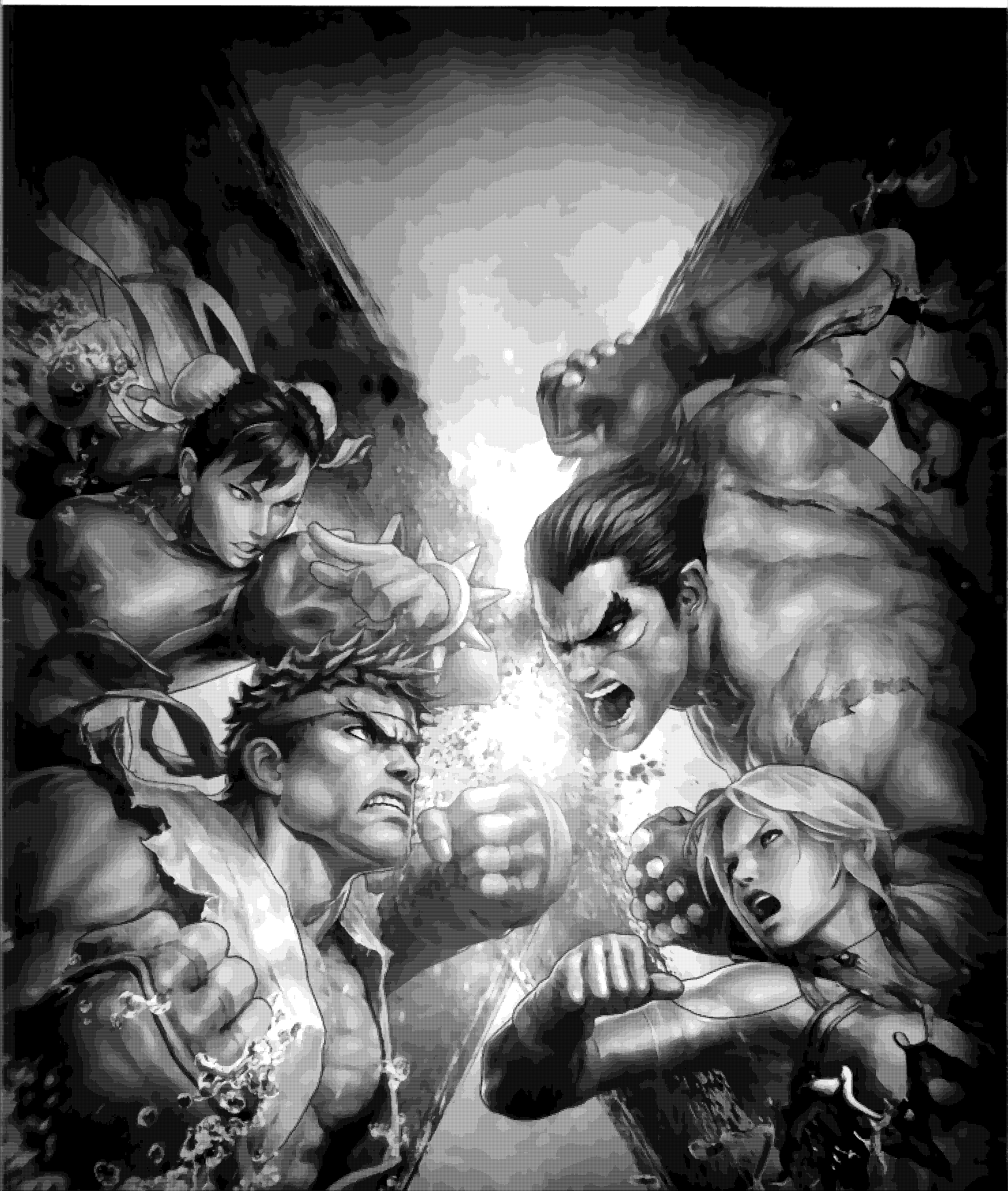
from
Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

I submitted about seven different drafts for the regular edition package art, and the one that ended up being chosen was the one with the simplest layout. The piece is easy to understand, with Ryu acting as the representative for the Street Fighter team and Kazuya acting as the representative for the Tekken team in this face-off. The most memorable aspect for me as far as working on this piece was the water theme of "SFxTK". Anyone who has seen the official trailer knows that the water is what brings the action to life. If there isn't enough water dancing around the characters, it all looks too static, so I just kept adding more and more water.



from
Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

in contrast to the package art for the regular edition, which showcased Ryu and Kazuya in a one-on-one fight, the package art for the collector's edition features quite a few characters from both Street Fighter and Tekken. I couldn't include every single character, and narrowing down my choices was the hardest part. Hugo is one of my personal favorites, so there was no way I'd leave him out. (laughs) Since the regular edition's package art was about conflict between Street Fighter and Tekken, I wanted the teams to be intermingled for the collector's edition.



From
Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Tashigawara)

Capcom USA gave me a general idea of what they wanted for this piece. I did my best to maintain their wishes while fine-tuning the layout, angle, and poses, then applied them to the models used in the trailer. These models were then rendered and sent to Capcom USA, who finished the piece and turned it into what you see here. I recall being blown away by how awesome it turned out to be, and that sparked a sense of friendly rivalry within me, making this piece particularly memorable for me.



From
Tamio (Capcom Design Studio)

I've spent a lot of time playing both of these game series, but I never dreamed I would get to draw them. I was super excited about it, but I feel like the final piece turned out a little heavy. Designing a label from the layout up was a pretty challenging task. The funniest part of the whole process was seeing Ryu age more and more into a middle-aged man with every approval check!



EXCLUSIVE COVER ART

From
Akiman

I've drawn Ryu countless times, but this was the first time I ever drew a Tekken character. I tried to convey Kazuya's aggressive personality in his facial expression. Ryu is a pretty neutral guy, and the different aspects of his unique nature are usually drawn out by the opponent he is facing. I admit I struggled more than I expected to when trying to balance Ryu's intensity with Kazuya's. The squared-off sparks of flame coming off of Ryu's fist were the little something that finally balanced it out for me.



Artist
Kinu Nishimura

Hello, Kinu Nishimura here! I drew up my usual Chun-Li and Cammy combo with two heroines from Tekken. This is one of those "collapse after a crazy long fight and there's a good laugh while telling each other how strong they are" situations. Ah, good times...

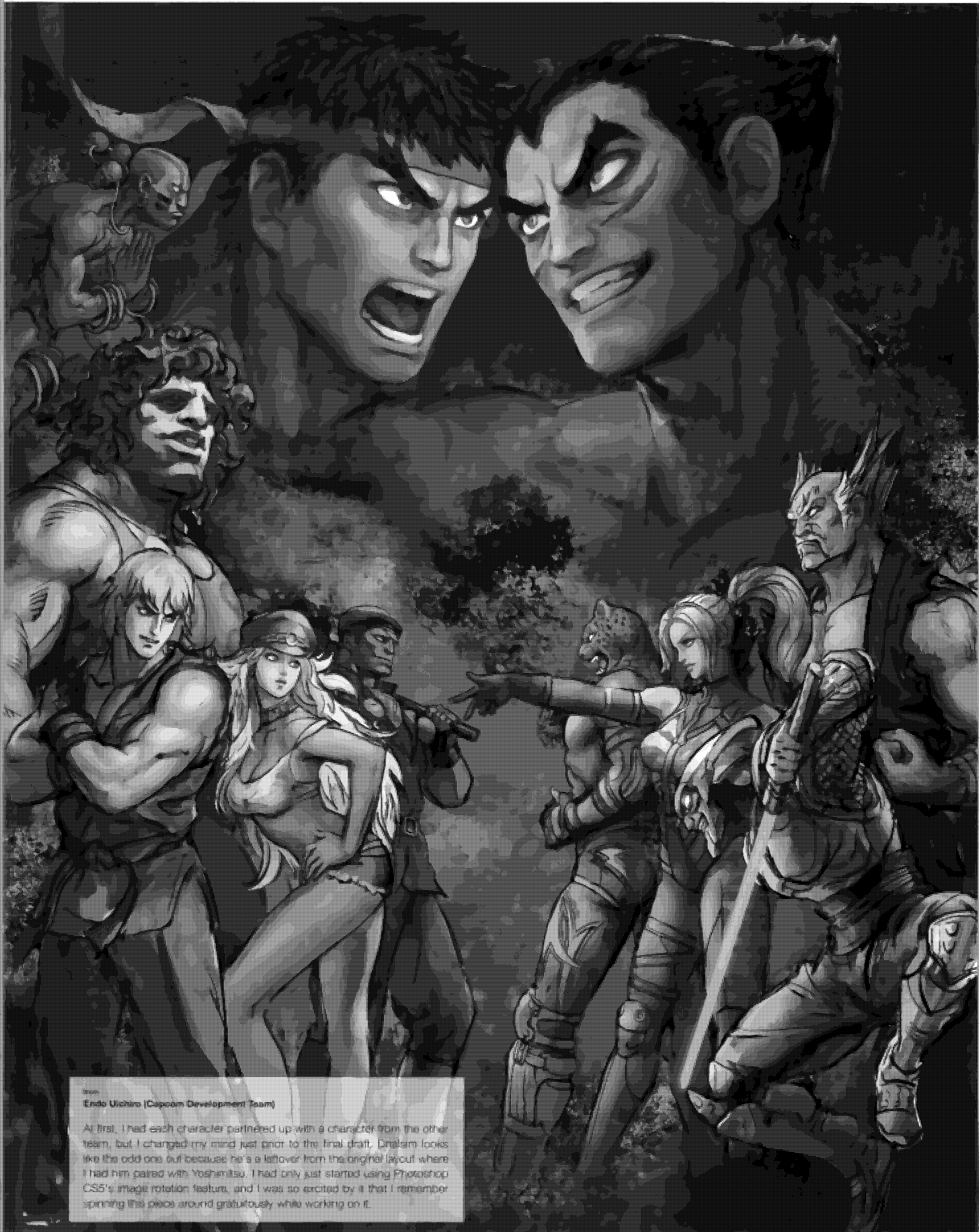


STREET FIGHTER X TEKKEN ARTWORKS™
ILLUSTRATION



by
Shunkei (Capcom Design Studio)

I was asked for an Akuma and Heihachi illustration. These two represent the extreme sides of Street Fighter and Tokken. I did my best to give the piece a hardcore vibe. I hope fans will pin this up in their bedrooms so that they can thoroughly enjoy the air of occasion waiting off of these grumpy old men.



Ken
Endo Uchino (Capcom Development Team)

At first, I had each character portraited up with a character from the other team, but I changed my mind just prior to the final draft. Dharma looks like the odd one out because he's a leftover from the original layout where I had him paired with Yoshimitsu. I had only just started using Photoshop CS5's image rotation feature, and I was so excited by it that I remember spinning this piece around gratuitously while working on it.

IPHONE COVER ILLUSTRATION

from

Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

The illustrations I did previously for "Street Fighter IV" were all done with a realistic touch, and I wanted to draw something that would really push the Capcom flavor to the forefront. That is what I attempted with this piece, and I was afraid it would be rejected for not incorporating the vibe of SFxTK. Much to my relief, however, it was approved. This is supposed to be a group shot of lovely ladies, but the most questionable participant also happens to be the one who stands out the most. (laughs)



**ILLUSTRATION: Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)**

Since Ryu is the main character, he always gets the most exposure. When drawing character illustrations, Ryu is the foundation upon which all of the other characters are based, so I get pretty nervous whenever I draw him. With regard to the posing for the character illustrations, I put a lot of thought into making them look good with their official tag partners. The only exceptions are Ryu and Kazuya, who are posed as rivals in battle. The idea is that Kazuya, as the representative of the Tekken team, is charging in to claim territory (page 34), and Ryu, as the representative of the Street Fighter team, is prepared to face him at Suzaku Castle.

www.Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

As far as I'm concerned, no Ken stage is complete without a luxurious cruise ship in the background. There was no way I'd leave that out of the piece. I'd say he purchased the ship sometime between "Street Fighter II" and "Street Fighter III". The skyscrapers in the background loom over the entire scene as symbols of Ken's position of authority in the corporate world.





from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

I was struggling with the character illustrations when I was told to "focus on the season" whenever I was in doubt. That's why each of the character illustrations has a certain season associated with it. I started this trend while I was working on Chun-Li, so I imagined her doing her early morning training on a crisp winter day. I think this setting allowed me to convey the refreshing nature of Chun-Li's character.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

I usually emphasize Cammy's hips from behind, but I decided to go with a frontal shot this time. Cammy's hips are always heavily scrutinized during the approval process, so this was an easy win. (laughs) Back when I was still in school, the England stage of "Super Street Fighter II" was my favorite. I had always wanted to draw that stage, and this illustration granted me the perfect opportunity. In contrast to Chun-Li's early winter morning, Cammy's illustration is set in a comfortable autumn evening.

from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

I wanted to emphasize Guile's strength with his pose in the hopes that it would show just how awesome he is. I put a lot of care into drawing Guile, of course, but I also paid quite a bit of attention to the jet in the background. It's the jet from Guile's stage in "Street Fighter II". I think I did a decent job of faithfully recreating the jet's form and wing. My only concern is that if the jet keeps rolling forward, it'll take Guile's head off... but we won't dwell on such semantics, will we? (laughs)



by Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

This illustration shows Abel boldly ripping through a door to infiltrate an enemy base. Abel's a relatively new character, so I had a lot of trouble figuring out what felt right as far as the layout, posing, and situation were concerned. One of the biggest issues was finding the right tone and balance for the colors. In the end, I decided to rally the piece around the color of Abel's gi.



■ Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

I settled on the pose pretty quickly, but the main obstacle was Dhalsim's Yoga Flame. Since the theme for this game is water, I tried to incorporate that into the Yoga Flame. Needless to say, I was worried about the response I would get for drawing the flame as something that is literally the complete opposite of a flame. I turned to the Hindu god Ganesha for inspiration when coloring the background. My color choices may seem a bit bold at first, but I think they actually suit Dhalsim's character quite well.



サガット

SAGAT

by Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Testagrosira)

A young Sagat wouldn't seem at all out of place busting up Angkor Wat, but since he is more mature now, I decided to draw him doing his thing on a bridge. The situation may not make much sense, but at least the Tiger Shot turned out nicely. If you take a moment to think about it, though, it's pretty safe to assume that Sagat took a long, nasty fall just moments after this image was captured... Fortunately, no one caught onto that little detail during the approval process.



■ Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

Rolento was a relatively easy character to draw because he is a pretty specifically defined character. This allowed me to pick a pose and layout without much doubt. With the tanks and explosions in the background, I think this piece turned out looking like the box art for a scale model or something. It'd be cool if someone released a "1/35 scale Rolento" figure. (laughs) Early drafts of this piece included more shrapnel in the background, but I lightened the load a bit to reach this state of balance.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Taniyama)

The scene where Ibuki was munching on a persimmon in the "Super Street Fighter IV" trailer left quite an impression on me, so I wanted to work some kind of food into this illustration. I chose sweet potatoes, which worked nicely with the autumn scenery. As a side note, I'm not sure when or how it happened, but it was decided that Ibuki needed some physical enhancement... so her breasts are now one and a half to two times larger than they used to be.

from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Tachigawa)

I based this design on the moment when a pro wrestler makes an unexpected appearance in the middle of the show. To tell you the truth, someone else was slated to draw this illustration, but I wasn't having any of that! (laughs) I insisted that I be allowed to draw Poison, and my enthusiasm was rewarded. I struggled a bit with her sexy facial expression, and the shape of her mouth in particular was trickier than I had anticipated. Still, as a result of my passionate efforts, I think Poison has the most alluring vibe compared to all of the other characters.

ヒューゴ

HUGO



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Takigawa)

This is Hugo's first appearance in a Capcom game since "Street Fighter II: 3rd Strike", so I gave him a grand entrance with him busting through the side of his trailer. It's his long-awaited revival! ... at least that's the message I was trying to convey. The setting is Metro City, the Mad Gear gang's old, glorious (?) stomping grounds. Hugo is the largest character in this game, so I used perspective to my advantage to ensure that this illustration would make a strong impact.

from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

Rufus and Bob are rivals, so I put them in opposing locations with a common theme. Bob (page 46) is in an expensive restaurant, while Rufus is in a cheap diner where he can get the junk food he loves so much. Some of the hamburger-loving staff members showed an unusual interest in exactly how I was going to depict the hamburger in the background. I hope you, too, will take the time to look at the details in the background.





from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

Even among the extra-muscular street fighters, Zangief stands a cut above the rest, making him a challenging character to draw. For this particular piece, I recall having to redo the liquid steel sloshing around in the background. Getting the texture of the heated metal just right was more difficult than I had expected. As a side note, I based the background on Zangief's "Street Fighter II" stage.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Testagrosara)

Vega's pose came to me easily, but I was quite stumped about what his background should be. I saw images of an old castle in things like the "Shadaloo's Secret Base" mock and Masahiro Nishitani's *Cammy* manga, which I thought would suit Vega quite well. All in all, I think the layout turned out very nicely. I considered adding a likeness of Vega to the stained glass window in the background to emphasize his narcissistic nature, but it looked a bit too comedic, so I decided against it.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Tachigawa)

Hours wasted away in front of a slot machine yielded no reward, and Balrog simply couldn't take it any longer. By smashing the damn slot machine open, Balrog finally got the pile of coins he was after. Describing this situation in text makes it sound a little silly, but I wasn't going for a comedic illustration. I focused on making Balrog look angry and intimidating, like the kind of guy you certainly wouldn't approach without good reason. I know Balrog was thought of as a comic relief-type character for a while, so I hope this illustration will restore him to his glory days in "Street Fighter II", where he was a former heavyweight champion and everyone knew he meant business.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

One thing that all of these "Sexy" illustrations have in common is the emphasis on perspective. All of the characters were drawn in action poses that make the best use of perspective, with M. Bison being a notable exception. By giving M. Bison very little movement and showing him directly from the front, I was hoping to convey that underhanded presence that only a boss character can offer. I was able to include just enough motion with his cape to assure that his illustration wouldn't be too boring when compared to the other characters, so I think it all worked out quite well. The background was based on the war room from the "Shadaloo's Secret Base" mode, with the glow and patterns being references to the source.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

This is Juri doing her thing in some base that she infiltrated. I suppose the details of the situation don't really matter. The important things were that the cracks on the wall look like spider webs, and that the poor soldiers that were used to make those cracks didn't look like they belonged to any particular organization. I thought I had paid enough attention to the latter point, so when a portion of overseas fans insisted that one of the victims looked like a specific character from a certain fighting game, I was more than a little surprised. I admit I like the character in question, but I promise that any resemblance is purely coincidental.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

Since Akuma didn't have a personal stage in "Street Fighter IV", I decided to refer to the background from his fight against Gouken in the trailer. Akuma's ending and his rival battle against Ryu also included a volcano, so I'm sure all of that played a part in my selection. The result was a powerful and intense illustration worthy of a man who has dedicated his life to walking a chaotic path. I think the notion of Akuma punching the ground and causing a volcano to erupt would make for an excellent "Pythagoras Switch" episode.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

Who would have expected to see the Mega Man from the North American box art here? There was a scene in Episode D of the trailer where Mega Man was being chased by Pac-Man, but I never would have guessed that the North American box art Mega Man would be in the actual game. I tried my best to reflect the vibe of the original box art in the "SFxTK" style. I think keeping the enemy character in the background in its original form gave this piece a sort of surreal feel. I hope the fans will accept this Mega Man along with the Roll who appears in the prologue.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

As the representative of the Tekken team, Kazuya is busting right into the Street Fighter series! To truly give off the invasion vibe, I wanted this piece to look strong and forceful. I knew going into this piece that it would often be shown next to Ryu's illustration (page 14), so I wanted them to look like they were actually interacting with each other instead of just standing side by side. I thought that this sort of posed conflict would better convey the nature of the "SFxTK" game. As expected, these two pieces were displayed as a pair on a number of occasions, so I was quite satisfied.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

Since Kazuya was making a frontal assault on the Street Fighter world, I wanted Nina to be taking advantage of that opportunity by flanking the enemy while they were distracted by Kazuya's bold antics. I drew this piece pretty early on, so we hadn't yet established the flow of transferring the 3D models into the illustrating process. That meant I had to spend a lot of time struggling with the complex costume design and the camouflage pattern. I was starting to worry about deadlines while working on this piece, so when it was approved, it gave me a real sense of hope with regard to all of the other character illustrations.



Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

Asuka's illustration and Lili's illustration go together as a set. Since both of them are females, I wanted Asuka's illustration to have just as much flair and just as many sparkles as Lili's. For the sparkles in Asuka's background, I thought parade lanterns would offer a lively and down-to-earth feel. I had actually played around with a few other background options, like having her on top of a ship or on a roof, but this one seemed to suit her better. I ended up using more colors than I had initially planned, but I believe the piece does a great job of representing Asuka's character.



by Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

Unlike Asuka's illustration, I knew what I wanted to do with Lili's background right away. In contrast to Asuka's "sparkling life of a commoner" theme, Lili shows us the sparkling decadence of celebrity life. We started off with what I thought was more than enough sparkles, but every time I checked the piece's progress, I couldn't help but add more. In the end, we had about three times more sparkles than what we had started with. As a side note, when it came to figuring out how to design the model to avoid showing glimpses of Lili's underwear in the trailer, we went with the obvious yet unexpected solution of "you can't catch a glimpse of something that isn't there!"



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

In "SFxTK", Heihachi is neither a main character nor a boss character. He was, however, the boss character of the original "Tekken" as well as the main character of the second generation, so he is one of the more well-known characters in the series. I gave him a cool pose to show that he is the "Tekken King" in order to assert his authority, but since comedy is also an essential facet of Heihachi's character, I put a lot of humor into his background. I had actually forgotten that Heihachi's Pandora shadow was supposed to be red and no one caught it until the last minute, which made for some very hectic editing.



mm Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

To show that Kuma is Hachi's tag partner, I put him in a similar but mirrored pose. Upon seeing him in that pose, I realized it looks like he's hunting salmon in the river, and the background basically came together on its own. The hardest part about drawing Kuma was the texture of his fur and the thickness of his hide. I went back to one of the original visual themes we had considered, which was the "carved sculpture" theme. I created a custom brush that gave the effect of carved wood, and it turned out to be the perfect tool for Kuma—though Kuma's was the only illustration where this brush actually saw any use.

◆ Polygon Pictures (Kazushige Nojima)

Paul is another character who was given a relatively important role early on in the series but became progressively more comedic as the series evolved. I thought I should give him at least a bit of his former dignity, so his pose is very straightforward and expresses strength. Since Paul is aiming to be the strongest fighter in the universe, I decided it would make sense for him to be fighting aliens. To that end, I took advantage of what I saw as an opportunity to bring in some of the more well-known Capcom aliens. If Paul manages to defeat all of the aliens in the background, it should be safe to say that he is the strongest fighter in the universe.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

Like Heihachi and Paul, players have come to expect silly things from Law. In Episode 3 of the trailer, Law's shop shows up in the background where Rufus and Bob are fighting. The Chinese text on the hanging divider is a warning against those who would try to leave without paying their bill. So what would Law do when dining at someone else's establishment? Well, he'd dine and dash, of course! Despite the ridiculous nature of the situation, Law's pose is one of the cooler ones out of all the illustrations, so I hope the gap in seriousness between the character and the background will get a few laughs.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

This illustration was one of the earlier ones that I did, so I struggled quite a bit with the layout and perspective. When viewed side by side with the illustration of his official tag partner Marduk, they look like they are executing synchronized lariats. The difference, of course, is that King is in an official pro wrestling ring. As with Ryu, King became a sort of learning tool that I used to familiarize myself with using the water to portray force, as well as melting the Pandora shadow into the rest of the illustration.

マードック

MARDUK



by Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Tachigawa)

In contrast to King's background, Marduk has been fighting in an underground cage ring. I used the movie "Fight Club" as an inspiration for this background. This was another illustration that I did early on, and it taught me a lot about blending the character with the background, as well as how to use things like mist and smoke. The muscles turned out looking quite nice in this style, though the body hair gave all of us some pause. We didn't want Marduk to look like a copy of Zangief, and I think the choices we made resulted in some powerfully stiff hair that suits the "Tekken" series.

**from Polygon Pictures (Kaname Teshigawara)**

Hwoarang is a young guy who is always buzzing with cool ideas and new fads. When I was mulling over ideas for this illustration, I happened to see a television commercial where they used clips of people practicing parkour, and I knew that was exactly the kind of thing Hwoarang would jump on. The speed, the cool vibe, and the legwork all suited Hwoarang perfectly, and this illustration was the result. At first I thought it'd be cooler to have him upside down, but that idea was rejected.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

I knew that Steve would be paired up with Hwoarang, so the pose was the easy part. The hard part was the background and specific situation. I couldn't put Steve in a ring because there was too much risk of similarity between his illustration and King's. On the other hand, I couldn't have him beating up civilians out on the street because that would be out of character for a guy like Steve. That's when I thought of making his pose the last stage of a transformation sequence, like the ones executed by magic anime girls who change into their hero costumes by spinning in an elaborate circle. The story is that a mob of drunks tried to start trouble with Steve, so he spun around and changed into his fighting gear!



■ Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

Bob's official tag partner is Julia, but his illustration is drawn to be paired with Rufus' (page 26). Though Bob and Rufus are both throwing tantrums in a restaurant environment, Bob always manages to be classier than Rufus. I thought that Bob would be relatively easy to draw since his costume is not particularly complex compared to those of the other Terren characters, but the wrinkles on his pants turned out to be quite troublesome. Every time I asked for the wrinkles to be redone, I swear I could see a Pandora shadow rising up from behind the person in charge of drawing them.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

Julia is an American woman who loves nature, but her fighting style is Chinese and her throwing moves are based on professional wrestling... so the difficult part was figuring out which of these disparate aspects of her character I should focus on. I didn't want Julia to be lacking in strength when compared to Bob, so I thought a baiquan pose would do the trick. One of the layout design submissions had prairie dogs in the lower right-hand corner, and I was pretty sure I'd make the artist in charge of drawing them cry if I chose this layout, but the prairie dogs were simply too cute to pass up. This illustration was done at around the time when we were all getting into the groove of things, and our schedule was starting to stabilize.

from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

Many of the "SF+Tok" illustrations include mist in one way or another, so the style was perfectly suited to a haunting and ghostly image, which is exactly what Yoshimitsu called for. The background came together quite smoothly, but Yoshimitsu himself offered a surprising amount of trouble. We got the basis for each character from their 3D model, and it was quite common for some design discrepancies to surface when creating illustrations from those models. Yoshimitsu, however, was extra challenging when it came to matching and balancing the illustration with his 3D model. Yoshimitsu is often considered to be the face of the Tekken series, and I was pleased that we got to portray the "Tokien 3" version of him.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

Everything, from the posing and layout to the actual drawing, went very smoothly with Raven, and I am quite pleased with the results. This piece is the perfect example of an ideal illustration in terms of the creation process. The one small speed bump we ran into was his weapon. When sheathed at his side, the tip of his blade actually sticks out a bit, and in truth, we placed a sheathed version of his weapon in his hand at first. I admit that I broke out into a minor sweat when I noticed our mistake.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigahara)

Jin himself easily fell into a simple, yet powerful pose. The problem was piecing his background together. I wanted to include things like his position within the Murai household, his role as a main character, his action from good to evil, the Devil Gene, wings, the undeniable aura of a boss character, a CEO's office, and dark clouds. Before I knew it, we had just piled everything into the image and ended up with quite a mess. We managed to work things out by minimizing and organizing the different elements, but it was a valuable lesson about being greedy with details. I later noticed that all of the Murai characters were posed with their feet out, but I promise that was not intentional.

シャオユ

XIAOYU



祝賀
スローロウ
場

from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

Crafting a Pandora shadow for a cheerful character is always tricky, but at least everyone got to have fun with the background... That is to say, everyone except the background artist who was actually responsible for drawing everything from Minaru and the other classmates to the panda and banner. I got everything I wanted out of this background, and I think the result speaks for itself. Xiaoyu's costume first changed in "Tekken 3", but her personality has been constant, so I wanted her to be depicted as the cute and lively girl that she is.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Teshigawara)

It's been over a decade since "Tekken 3" first came out, and I never would have expected to be drawing Ogre now... He was the most memorable of the non-human bosses in Tekken, though I feel like I never truly appreciated just how tall his helmet is. I kept asking for minor edits right up until the last minute in order to squeeze out every last drop of intrigue and boss-like intensity that I could get. This piece is a masterful blend of 2D and 3D, with the small metal embellishments bringing the 3D aspect to life, and the hand making great use of 2D space.



from Polygon Pictures (Kazuma Tashigawara)

I'm sure everyone was surprised by Pac-Man's appearance in the game, but I doubt anyone was as surprised as we were over here at Polygon Pictures. "What's going to happen to him when he is depicted in the SFxT's style?" That was the question none of us could answer until we finally saw the finished piece. One of the layout ideas was to have Pac-Man "conquering" a Capcom arcade center and planting a Namco flag on the roof, celebrating his victory with his trademark smile and thumbs-up pose... Thinking back on it now, I'm surprised we didn't get in trouble just for suggesting an idea like that.